



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Humans have always had a fascination with whales.



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How would you feel if you saw a whale in real life?
- What do you know about whales?

Can Do Statements

- I can describe environmental problems.
- I can talk about things that are happening and things that have happened.
- I can talk about cause and effect, and hypothetical situations.

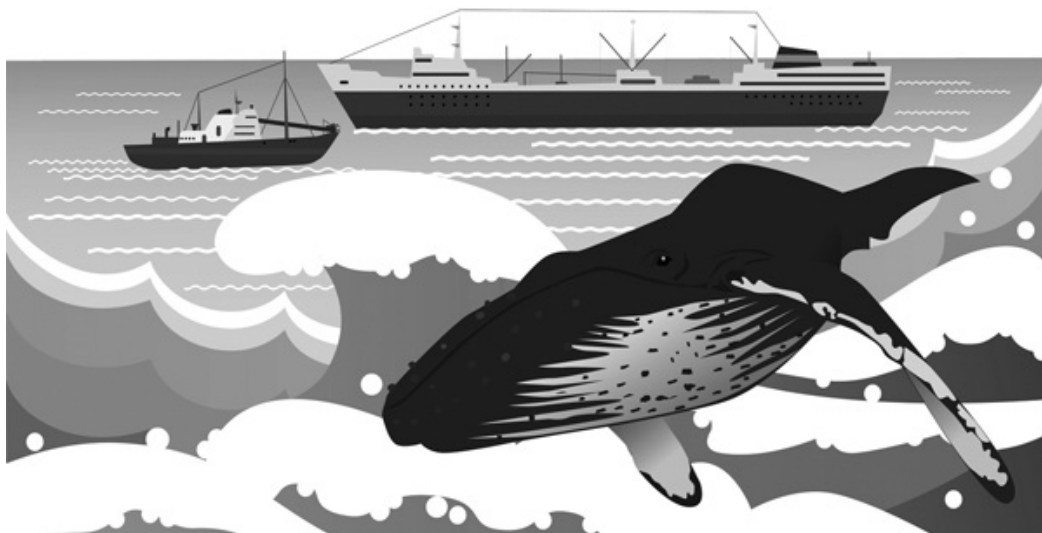




Let's Explore!

Let's read about whales and how to stop the killing of whales. Why was the **bowhead whale*** hunted?

* The "*bowhead whale*" is a dark-colored whale that lives in the Arctic waters.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Humans have always had a fascination with whales. They have been the subjects of movies and children's stories. Have you heard of the movie *Free Willy*? It grossed 157 million dollars worldwide.

Unfortunately, whales are also the subject of environmentalists' concerns. Whereas whale sightings were once a common event in waters around the world, today certain whales are in jeopardy of becoming extinct. Certain species of whale, like the bowhead whale, have been hunted for their whale oil. Whale oil was obtained by boiling strips of blubber harvested from whales. This, of course, means killing the whale and oftentimes, disposing of its carcass which was of no further use. Fortunately, this practice has been outlawed since the 1980s. If this legislation had been introduced earlier, the bowhead whale would not have become endangered.

One way to stop whale killing is to get involved. It might seem a little strange, but it is possible to "adopt" a whale and protect the species from extinction. Environmental groups are collecting donations through "adopt-a-whale" projects. The money they raise from these "adoptions" is being used to rescue whales from fishing nets, help enforce wildlife protection laws, and do research.

The project is also educating people and public awareness is being raised. If people are made more aware of this issue, further research and development of preservation strategies can be achieved. If you could adopt a whale, would you?





Let's Practice!

Tell me more about whales!

Instructions: Complete the text below by choosing from the words below. Use the sentences (the text) to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

Word Bank

Fascinated / jeopardy / blubber / harvested / outlawed / fascination / in jeopardy

I've always had a _____ with whales.

An orca was the subject of the movie *Free Willy*, which grossed 157 million dollars worldwide.

Today certain whales are _____ of becoming extinct. This is because of past hunting practices.

Whale oil was obtained by boiling strips of _____ from whales.

Fortunately, this practice was _____ in the 1980s.



Let's Practice!

What do you know about whales? Tell me!

Instructions: Practice saying the following sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor. Use the sentences (the text) to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

1. Humans have always had a fascination with whales.
2. They have been the subjects of movies and children's stories.
3. Certain species of whale, like the bowhead whale, have been hunted for their whale oil.
4. Fortunately, this practice has been outlawed since the 1980s.
5. Environmental groups are collecting donations through "adopt-a-whale" projects.
6. The money they raise from these "adoptions" is being used to rescue whales from fishing nets.
7. The project is also educating people and public awareness is being raised.





Extension Activity

Watch the movie *Free Willy*.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Watch the movie *Free Willy*.
- Then, research what happened to the whale that starred in the movie.
- Discuss what you found out about the whale.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch the movie *Free Willy*.

☐
☐

I think about the future of whales in the world.

☐
☐

I identify what happened to the whale from *Free Willy*.

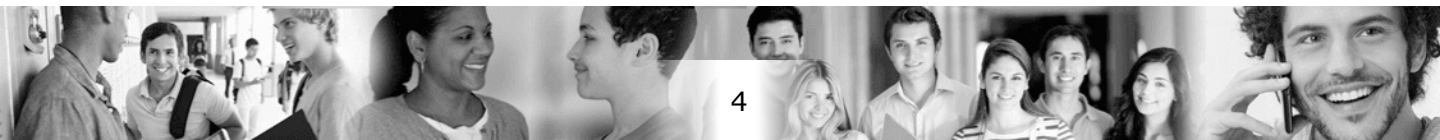
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I discuss the issue of endangered species.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **fascination** (noun): having a great interest in something
e.g. Humans have always had a fascination with whales.
- **subject** (noun): topic of interest
e.g. Whales have been the subjects of movies and children's stories.
- **to gross** (verb): to earn as a total profit
e.g. 'Free Willy', the movie, grossed 157 million dollars worldwide.
- **to be in jeopardy** (expression): to be in danger
e.g. Today certain whales are in jeopardy of becoming extinct.
- **to outlaw** (verb): to declare illegal
e.g. Hunting of the bowhead whale was outlawed in the 1980s.
- **blubber** (noun): the fat of whales
e.g. Whale oil was obtained by boiling strips of blubber taken from whales.
- **carcass** (noun): the body of a dead animal
e.g. This means killing the whale and oftentimes, disposing of its carcass.
- **to harvest** (verb): to gather
e.g. Blubber was harvested from whales to produce whale oil.





Learning Points

The Passive: The Present Continuous and Present Perfect Tenses

You use the Present Continuous to talk about an action that is happening at the time of speaking. The action or event is in progress.

*Environmental groups **are collecting** donations through "adopt-a-whale" projects.*

You use the Present Perfect to talk about a finished action or event with present consequences. There is a connection between what happened in the past and the present.

***Have** you **heard** of the movie Free Willy?*

You often choose the passive form when you want to talk about an action but are not so interested in saying who or what does/did it. Passives without *agents* (the doers) are common in academic and scientific writing.

Look at the chart below for the structure of the passive voice.

Name	Structure	Example
Present Continuous	<i>am/are/is + being + past participle</i>	<i>The money they raise from these "adoptions" is being used to rescue whales from fishing nets.</i>
Present Perfect	<i>have/has + been + past participle</i>	<i>Fortunately, this practice has been outlawed since the 1980s.</i>

Examples:

- *Humans have always had a fascination with whales.*
- *They have been the subjects of movies and children's stories.*
- *Certain species of whale, like the bowhead whale, have been hunted for their whale oil.*
- *Environmental groups are collecting donations through "adopt-a-whale" projects.*
- *The money they raise from these "adoptions" is being used to rescue whales from fishing nets, help enforce wildlife protection laws, and do research.*
- *The project is also educating people and public awareness is being raised.*



Learning Points

Conditional Sentences

There are four types of conditional sentences in English:

1. Zero Conditional - to talk about certainty and facts
2. First Conditional - to talk about real possibilities in the present or the future
3. Second Conditional - to talk about *unreal* possibilities in the present or the future
4. Third Conditional - to talk about unreal *past* situations

You use the third conditional to talk about unreal situations in the past. These are things that did not happen in the past. You often use the third conditional to talk about regrets.

Look at the chart below to compare the structure of each kind of conditional:

Conditional Name	Structure	Example
Zero	<i>If + Simple Present, Simple Present</i>	<i>If you heat ice, it melts.</i>
First	<i>If + Simple Present, will + Simple Present</i>	<i>If people are made more aware of this issue, further research and development of preservation strategies can be achieved.</i>
Second	<i>If + Simple Past, would + Simple Present</i>	<i>If you could adopt a whale, would you? If you were to donate to a charity, which one would you choose and why?</i>
Third	<i>If + Past Perfect, would have + past participle</i>	<i>If this legislation had been introduced earlier, the bowhead whale would not have become endangered.</i>

Note: In the second conditional, it is grammatically correct to use *If I were ...* rather than *If I was ...*

You may hear people say *If I was ...* in conversation. In writing, you should use *If I were ...*

